



VOTE NO ON MEASURE PFD

Support Firefighters. Stop the Unfair Tax.

We Support Pasadena's Firefighters. We Oppose an Unfair Tax.

Pasadena's firefighters and paramedics deserve strong support. They respond to every call, from a heart attack on Colorado Boulevard to a brush fire in the foothills. **Emergency services protect the entire community. Measure PFD is the WRONG solution.** City Hall wants a 19-cent-per-square-foot parcel tax, locked in for 14 years, to generate about \$22.1 million a year. **A typical 1,600-square-foot home would pay about \$304 a year, or \$4,256 before the tax expires.** A 20,000-square-foot apartment building would owe about \$3,800 a year. Supporting firefighters does not require approving every tax.

Everyone Relies on Firefighters. Only Property Owners Pay.

Firefighters and paramedics serve homeowners and renters, workers and commuters, tourists, Rose Bowl crowds, and people experiencing homelessness. Measure PFD sends the bill to one group: property owners. Square footage has nothing to do with who calls 911. Emergency medical calls, not building fires, account for most Fire Department responses. In 2021, the Department answered more than 17,000 calls, of which more than 13,000 were medical. A bigger building does not mean more 911 calls. A citywide service deserves a citywide, fairer funding plan.

A City That Keeps Getting More Expensive

Pasadena families already face some of the country's highest housing costs. Insurance, utilities, groceries, and property taxes are rising faster than paychecks. Voters have stepped up before. Pasadena approved parcel taxes for the Central Library and the school district. **City and school measures since 2020 already add more than \$1,700 in new taxes for many.** On October 1, a half-cent county sales tax hike, passed by L.A. County voters in June, reaches every checkout counter. Politicians talk about affordability but pass policies and taxes that make Pasadena less affordable. Measure PFD piles on. Enough is enough.

The Forgotten Middle Pays the Most

For wealthy homeowners, \$304 a year is a rounding error. **For a retiree on a fixed income, a young family stretching to cover a mortgage, or a longtime homeowner watching every bill climb, Measure PFD can mean the difference between staying in Pasadena and getting priced out.** These neighbors earn too much to qualify for assistance and too little to absorb another tax increase. Only qualifying low-income seniors receive an exemption. Apartment properties, small housing providers, businesses, and other owners receive no comparable protection.

Renters Pay, Too

Most Pasadena households rent. Renters will never see a Measure PFD bill, yet they live in the buildings that must pay it. Measure PFD taxes apartment buildings on every improved square foot. Family-owned small housing providers keep Pasadena's older, more affordable apartments running on thin margins. Rent

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control limits what they collect. Taxes, insurance, and repairs keep rising anyway. The pressure lands somewhere: deferred repairs, fewer upgrades, higher rents on new leases or buildings sold to bigger investors. **Pasadena should fight fires without fueling the housing crisis.**

The Eaton Fire Deserves Better Than a Sales Pitch

The Eaton Fire devastated our neighbors. We honor every firefighter who fought it. Proponents cite the Eaton Fire to push an inequitable tax. **County and state fire investigators determined that electrical arcing from utility equipment caused the disaster. Honoring our firefighters does not require a 14-year tax on only one slice of the community.**

A 14-Year Check With No Strings Attached

Measure PFD guarantees tax collections. The measure does lock in seismic retrofits at two fire stations. **Beyond those two, nothing in Measure PFD guarantees completed repairs at the other stations, faster response times, successful recruitment, or fewer overlapping emergencies.** Annual audits merely track spending after the money leaves taxpayers' pockets. Voters deserve a project schedule, performance standards, protection for existing fire funding, a housing-impact study and a midterm public review. Measure PFD offers none of them.

You Already Paid for Fire Stations. Now They Want You to Pay Again.

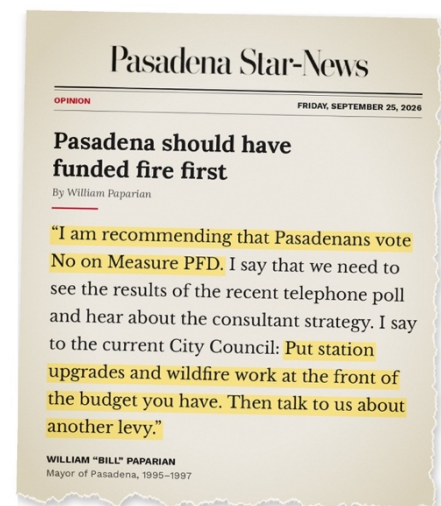
Pasadena voters paid once already. In 2018, they approved Measure I, a permanent three-quarter-cent sales tax, sold in part to "keep fire stations open." Today, Measure I brings in about \$32 million. About \$10.7 million goes to PUSD under Measure J. The city's share goes to the general fund, with no lock on fire stations. In June 2019, the capital budget recommended \$1.5 million to design a replacement for Station 37, at 3430 East Foothill, then estimated at \$21.3 million. On June 12, Mayor Tornek said those dollars would be better used for short-term repairs. On June 17, the Council voted to make that transfer. **Stations 33 and 37, the two facilities named in Measure PFD, remain unfunded. Voters paid for the upgrades once. City Hall moved the design money and left both stations waiting. Now City Hall wants voters to pay again.**

Pasadena Leaders Say: Not This Plan

Former Mayor Bill Paparian, who served on the City Council from 1987 to 1999, put the case plainly in the Pasadena Star-News on September 25, 2026:

A Better Plan Is Within Reach

A NO vote does not leave Pasadena unprotected. Firefighters continue to respond. City Hall needs to return with a fairer plan that shares costs among everyone who benefits, sets measurable performance standards, and protects existing fire funding. A better plan starts with a housing-impact study, a project schedule, and response-time benchmarks. It pairs response funding with fire prevention, including encampment-related fire risk. Then City Hall can ask voters again.



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